



EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE

Understanding and Managing Emotions

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15%

of people have challenges
managing their emotions

99%

of people with **high levels** of
resilience effectively manage
their emotions

81%

of people with **average levels** of
resilience effectively manage
their emotions

8%

of people with **low levels** of
resilience effectively manage
their emotions



Understanding and Managing Emotions

SCENARIO

A colleague is promoted to a position you think you more rightfully deserve.



What do you think / say / feel / do?

You may experience anger, jealousy, disappointment or resentment. These emotions can evoke three types of response:



THOUGHTS

“Why them not me?” “My manager must dislike me &/or consider that I am incompetent” “I am being overlooked” “Why should I bother in future?” “I’m embarrassed by how this may make my colleagues perceive me.”



PHYSICAL FEELINGS

Sweating, tension, rapid breathing.



BEHAVIOURS

Being aggressive towards or avoiding your colleague, phoning your partner to have a moan, demanding a discussion with your boss.

Recognising these emotional responses can help you to:

- understand that emotions are responsible.
- prevent emotional thoughts and feelings from turning into actions.
- identify your emotional triggers and negative patterns of thinking and behaving.

Managing Emotions



Emotions and emotional responses result from an interplay between the amygdala and the pre-frontal cortex.



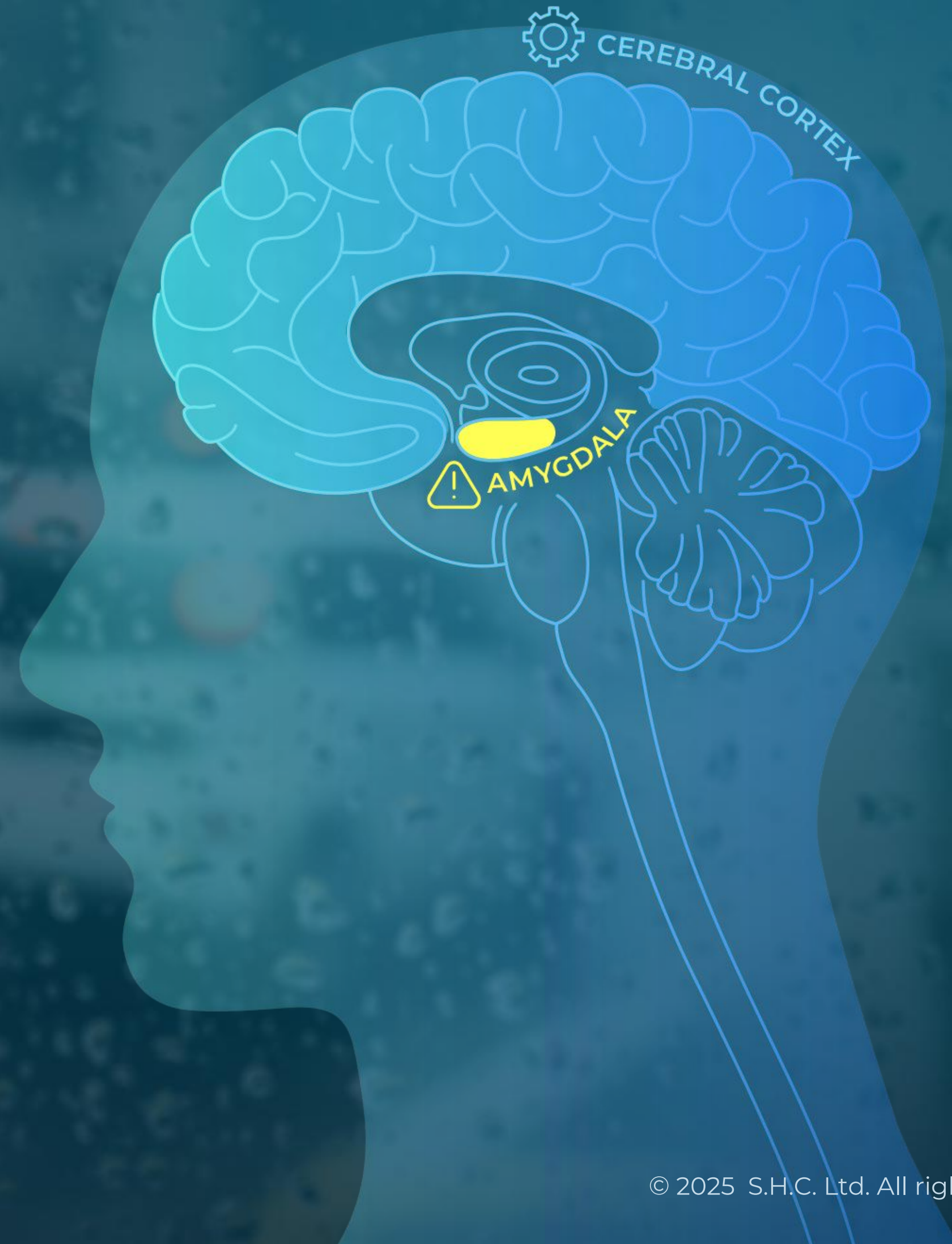
The amygdala, part of the limbic system, controls automatic lower order brain processes characterised by instinct and speed, for example, the 'fight, flight or freeze' response.



The pre-frontal cortex evaluates what is happening.



Managing emotions involves strategies to delay this response so that the logical part of the brain (pre-frontal cortex), can take over and respond appropriately.



The Value of Emotions



THEY KEEP YOU PHYSICALLY SAFE

They get your attention and drive you to take action.



THEY HAVE SOCIAL VALUE

Emotions such as shame, compassion, love and empathy enable us to live and work together.



THEY HAVE CREATIVE VALUE

Sadness and despair can inspire poetry, music, art, and also provoke emotions, although conversely, they can also paralyse creativity.



THEY MOTIVATE YOU TO TAKE ACTION

Even negative emotions such as the fear of exams can motivate us to revise. Similarly, regret can motivate you to learn from mistakes and adopt a different course of action the next time.

The Three Categories Of Emotion

1 PRIMARY

Joy →
Sadness →
Disgust →
Surprise →
Fear →
Anger →

2 SECONDARY

Cheerfulness, Contentment, Optimism →
Suffering, Disappointment, Shame →
Disgust →
Surprise →
Horror, Nervousness →
Envy, Irritation, Exasperation, Rage →

3 TERTIARY

Cheerfulness, Contentment, Pride, Optimism, Relief
Suffering, Disappointment, Shame, Neglect, Regret
Revulsion, Contempt, Loathing
Amazement, Astonishment
Alarm, Fright, Panic, Hysteria, Anxiety, Apprehension
Jealousy, Grumpiness, Resentment, Agitation, Frustration

Tracing Back to the Primary Emotion

We can use these categories to trace a person's reaction back to the primary emotion. This can help to explain people's behaviour, motivation and responses.

EXAMPLE



You feel **apprehensive**
The primary emotion is **fear**
You need reassurance



You feel **frustrated**
The primary emotion is **anger**
You need to calm down

Successfully Managing Emotions

To successfully manage your emotions you will need to be able to:

1

Know when to respond immediately, and when to stop and think.

2

Know whether it is appropriate to engage with or detach from an emotion.

3

Know the boundaries – what is an appropriate / inappropriate emotional response in this situation?

4

Manage other peoples' emotions.

5

Use emotions to build rapport and empathy with others.

Blocking emotions is stressful and exhausting, acting as a barrier to developing good relationships.

Staying open to both pleasant and unpleasant emotions, and adopting flexible thinking, will allow you to direct and influence your thoughts, feelings and behaviours.

The Benefits of Managing Emotions in The Workplace

By understanding and regulating emotions, individuals can better navigate conflicts, reduce stress, and foster a sense of well-being, contributing to a more productive and harmonious workplace.



Enhanced Communication

Managing emotions effectively leads to improved communication and empathy, promoting stronger understanding and teamwork.



Stronger Relationships

Understanding emotions fosters interpersonal skills, including empathy, resulting in more positive and productive relationships with colleagues.



Increased Productivity

When individuals manage their emotional responses, they are able to maintain concentration and focus, leading to higher levels of productivity and efficiency.



Reduced Conflict

Managing emotions allows individuals to respond to conflict in a constructive manner, preventing escalation and promoting resolution.



Positive Work Environment

A culture where emotions are acknowledged and managed constructively fosters a more positive, supportive, and engaging atmosphere.



Improved Decision-Making

Understanding their emotional responses helps individuals make more considered and rational decisions, particularly in high-pressure situations.



Increased Resilience

Being able to manage emotions effectively contributes to greater resilience, enabling individuals to bounce back from setbacks and challenges.



Greater Job Satisfaction

When individuals feel understood, respected, and supported in the workplace this increases job satisfaction and sense of belonging.



Leadership Effectiveness

Leaders with the ability to manage their emotions effectively are better equipped to inspire, motivate, and guide their teams.

Managing Emotions - Best Practice



OWN YOUR EMOTIONS

You cannot influence how others behave, you CAN influence / control your emotional response.



KNOW YOUR EMOTIONAL TRIGGERS

Develop strategies to respond consciously and purposefully rather than automatically.



MANAGE THE PHYSICAL FEELINGS

Practice slow breathing, count to ten, go for a brisk walk, listen to music.



REFLECT ON WHAT WENT WRONG

How can you respond in a more appropriate way in future?



REMEMBER TO STOP AND THINK

Is your default response correct?
How will you feel about the situation tomorrow? (example- writing an angry email in response to something at work).



CONSCIOUSLY DECIDE HOW TO REACT

If you miss out on a promotion, you can either complain OR you can ask for feedback.



BE ASSERTIVE WHEN NECESSARY

Be assertive where achieving a specific outcome is important to you, but accept that there are probable risks and consequences of your assertion, including making things worse.



DEVELOP POSITIVE THINKING

Acknowledge the difficulties in a situation but focus on the good things, see the best in others, be positive about yourself, your abilities and emotions, and nurture positive 'self-talk'.



Understanding and Managing Emotions

EXERCISE

Imagine a client calls you and tells you the project you have been working on for 6 months is cancelled.



What Emotions, Thoughts, Physical Feelings and Behaviours would you experience?



How could you better manage this emotional response in future?



Understanding and Managing Emotions

EXERCISE

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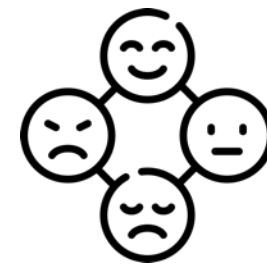


What Emotions, Thoughts, Physical Feelings and Behaviours would you experience?



How could you better manage this emotional response in future?

What Emotions, Thoughts, Physical Feelings and Behaviours would you experience?



EMOTIONS

You might react angrily.



THOUGHTS

“What a waste of my time.”



PHYSICAL FEELINGS

Tension, accelerated breathing, over-heating.



BEHAVIOURS

Complain loudly to colleagues, manager or customer.



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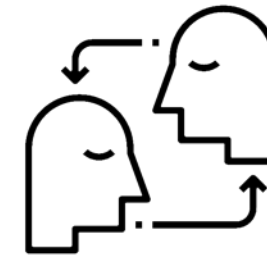


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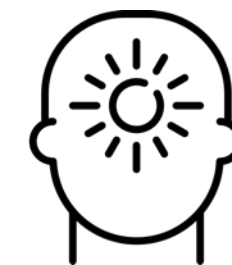
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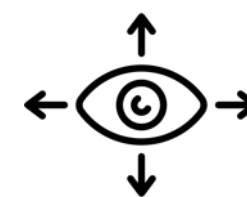
ACKNOWLEDGE YOUR AND OTHERS' FEELINGS

Understand that the cancellation can't have been easy for the client either and react accordingly. Take a moment to gather your thoughts and control the physical feelings before responding, (use breathing techniques if that helps). The outcome you require is to remain on good terms with this customer.



THINK POSITIVE

Rather than feeling frustrated or disappointed, take the positives from this -all your hard work will not go to waste since you have learnt a great deal throughout the process and can apply it to other projects.



GAIN PERSPECTIVE

You have built good relationships with this client and have been part of a large multidisciplinary team. This will stand you in good stead for acquiring future work from the original client or via other project members.



BE PRAGMATIC

The project may be reinstated as has happened previously with this client.